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# Format your report text

Activity · Slide Decks · ~10 min

## BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You have a slide with interpretation text that needs structure (a heading, a bulleted list, or some bold emphasis)
- ☐ The slide is open in the editor

## WHY IT MATTERS

Plain paragraphs hide the message. A heading, a few bullets, and one bolded phrase pull the reader through the slide in the order you want.

## The shortcuts

You can format text using simple symbols, the same way you would in a chat message. The editor turns the symbols into formatted text as soon as you save.

| Symbol                         | Result          |
|--------------------------------|-----------------|
| # Heading                      | Large heading   |
| ## Subheading                  | Smaller heading |
| **bold**                       | <b>bold</b>     |
| Start a line with - (a hyphen) | Bullet point    |
| Leave a blank line             | Add spacing     |

## Try it

1. Open one of your existing slides and click into the text area.
2. Turn the first line into a heading by adding ## in front of it.
3. Pick one phrase that carries the key message and wrap it in \*\*...\*\* to bold it.
4. If the slide has more than one idea, split them into bullets by starting each line with - .
5. Save and check the rendered slide.

## Checkpoint

Your slide should now have:

- A heading or subheading that names what the slide is about
- Bullets where you have a list, rather than a single paragraph
- One or two phrases bolded for emphasis (not more, or the emphasis loses force)

## What could go wrong

- **The symbols still show on the rendered slide** — you probably forgot the space after the `#` or `-`. The shortcut needs the space ( `# Heading` , not `#Heading` ).
- **Everything is bolded** — `**` wrap only the phrase you want to emphasise, not whole paragraphs.
- **Bullets run into each other** — leave a blank line between bullets and the next paragraph to add spacing.

## What's next

The next activity covers report settings: name, style, logos, and page numbers.